

DeepSeek, the Chinese AI lab, has had a rollercoaster of a day. The company, whose open-source AI solution was the talk of the tech town for most of Monday, January 27, fell prey to a large-scale cyber attack and has limited user registration as it scrambles to contain the fallout.

DeepSeek has confirmed the attack and said it is taking precautionary steps to mitigate any further damage, though the extent of the attack is unclear for the moment. The incident has raised concerns about the security of user data and the integrity of the platform, which saw a swift rise to prominence over the past couple of days, thanks to its R1 AI model, which can supposedly match or even outperform OpenAI's most advanced model at a fraction of the cost.

This led to a surge in users downloading the company's apps on mobile platforms or using the source code on their computers. On Monday, DeepSeek dethroned OpenAI's ChatGPT as the most downloaded app on Apple's App Store in the United States.

The company said it is currently investigating the breach and working closely with cybersecurity experts to assess the extent of the attack. The company has also urged users to be on their toes and monitor their accounts for any suspicious activity.

DeepSeek has also assured its users that it will implement robust security measures to prevent such incidents in the future and that it will send official communications through various channels on the steps users must take to safeguard their data.

While a cyber attack is not unexpected, the swiftness — and the scale — are, frankly, astonishing. This only goes on to highlight that the threat of cybercrime is always just below the surface.